ANSWER KEY

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MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/ MGU-BBA (Honours)/ MGU-BCA (Honours)

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Fifth SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG5DSCPOL300, MG5DSCPJM300

INDIAN POLITICAL THOUGHT

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

PART A

1. Feminism/Gender Equality

2. Dadabhai Naoroji

3. Preferential Opportunities for Societal Rejuvenation

4. M. N. Roy

5. Hind Swaraj

6. Raja Ram Mohan Roy

7. Jyotirao Phule

8. Ramakrishna Mission

9. Knighthood

10. Pondicherry (Puducherry)

PART B

11.Buddhism enriched Shramanic thought- rejected Vedic ritualism and questioned Brahmanical authority-emphasised the Four Noble Truths- the Eightfold Path- non-violence, compassion, and ethical conduct-its teachings challenged social inequalities and presented liberation as achievable through wisdom, discipline, and personal effort rather than ritual sacrifices.

12.Founded by Pandita Ramabai in 1889 at Kedgaon, Maharashtra-Mukti Mission promoted women's education, rehabilitation and empowerment-supported vulnerable women, widows, and children-its vocational activities have included tailoring, weaving, agriculture, printing,

and other practical skills- encouraged economic independence, self-reliance, and dignity among disadvantaged communities.

13.Muhammad Iqbal's concept of *Khudi*- in Urdu *Khudi*- translates literally to "selfhood", "self-consciousness"- signifies the development of a strong, self-aware, morally responsible individual- *Khudi* is not arrogance or mere pride- emphasises self-realisation, discipline, courage, creativity and purposeful action- the ideal Islamic personality cultivates spiritual strength through faith and ethical responsibility- actively transforming society while striving towards closeness to God.

14. Ambedkar described caste as a "division of labourers" rather than merely a division of labour- because it hierarchically organises people by birth- caste system imposes hereditary occupations- restricts occupational mobility- perpetuates graded inequality- unlike functional specialisation, caste denies individual freedom, dignity, fraternity and equal opportunities.

15. Dalit-Bahujan political thought challenges caste oppression- Brahmanical dominance- untouchability- social exclusion- advocates equality, dignity, representation, social justice, and redistribution of power- drawing on thinkers such as Phule, Ambedkar, and Periyar, it promotes education, constitutional rights, collective mobilisation, and the emancipation of oppressed communities.

16. Kautilya- *Arthashastra*-advocates an efficient, disciplined, and centralised administrative system under a responsible monarch- emphasised ministerial selection- bureaucratic accountability- taxation- espionage- justice and economic management- ruler's welfare depends upon public welfare- effective administration ensures security, prosperity, stability and political order.

17. Abul Fazl-Akbar's court historian and adviser- advocated Sulh-i-Kul- meaning universal peace- he supported religious tolerance, rational inquiry and inclusive governance- irrespective of religious differences- his political philosophy encouraged dialogue among faiths- challenged sectarian prejudice- helped to develop an imperial vision of coexistence and political unity.

18. E. V. Ramasamy Periyar- challenged caste hierarchy, untouchability, Brahmanical domination and gender inequality- Self-Respect Movement- promoted rationalism, self-respect, inter-caste marriage, women's rights, and equal access to education- radical social philosophy sought to dismantle oppressive traditions and establish dignity, equality, and social justice.

19. Gandhi opposed untouchability and campaigned for the dignity of oppressed communities- although his historical defence of varna differed significantly from Ambedkar's rejection of caste- he encouraged women's participation in public life- advocated non-violence- promoted village reconstruction- communal harmony- constructive social reform.

20. Jawaharlal Nehru advocated secularism, religious freedom, and equal citizenship in a pluralistic India- opposed communalism and religious discrimination- emphasised scientific temper, rational inquiry, and democratic institutions- his vision sought national integration through constitutional equality, cultural diversity, modern education- a state independent of religious domination.

PART C

21. Barani viewed the Sultan as the guardian of Islamic law and political order- although Shariat provided moral and religious legitimacy- he recognised the practical necessity of royal regulations (Zawabit) for effective governance- his political thought combined religious orthodoxy- hierarchical social organisation- state authority- subordinated political decisions to Islamic principles while accommodating administrative necessities.

22. Ram Mohan Roy embraced Western liberalism- Enlightenment rationalism- individual liberty- constitutional government- critically engaged with Indian traditions- he advocated freedom of the press- judicial reform- religious toleration- civil rights- his petitions and public interventions helped shape early constitutional discourse- Roy's reformist politics remained largely elite-led and did not establish universal democratic participation.

23. Bal Gangadhar Tilak-extremist phase- transformed Indian nationalism through assertive political mobilisation and resistance to British rule- his declaration that Swaraj was a birthright popularised self-government- Swadeshi movement and public festivals encouraged mass participation- his methods challenged moderate constitutional politics- Tilak's nationalism also contained social conservatism and sometimes relied on religious-cultural symbols.

24. Sri Narayana Guru connected spiritual realisation with social equality-challenged caste discrimination through ethical and religious reform- his principle, "One caste, one religion, one God for humankind"- emphasised shared human dignity-social action through education-temple consecrations- institutional initiatives- encouraged oppressed communities' empowerment- demonstrated that inner transformation must support external social justice and collective progress.